INTERVIEW GUIDE

# Interview Confidence

A practical interview practice companion with worksheets and prompts

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CHAPTER 01 / PREPARATION

# Understand the role before practising

A useful interview is a conversation about how you could contribute to the work. Start with the actual job description, not a memorized answer.

## Research checklist

- Read the job description and underline repeated requirements.
- Review the official employer website for products and work.
- Write three examples that show relevant skills.
- Prepare two thoughtful questions about the team or role.

### A strong 60-second introduction

I am [BACKGROUND], interested in [TARGET ROLE]. Recently, I worked on [REAL PROJECT OR TASK], where I learned [RELEVANT SKILL]. I am particularly interested in this role because [SPECIFIC CONNECTION].

CHAPTER 02 / STORYTELLING

# Build a story bank with STAR

Prepare examples you can reuse without repeating the same story for every question.

| Story type | Possible source |
| --- | --- |
| Solving a problem | A class project, internship or real job |
| Working with others | Teamwork, club or volunteer group |
| Learning quickly | New tool, coursework or self-study |
| Handling feedback | A revision you made after critique |

## STAR worksheet

- Situation: One sentence of context.
- Task: What was expected of you?
- Action: What did you personally do?
- Result: What happened, and what did you learn?

Avoid invented numbers or exaggerated responsibility. A small, honest story is better than a dramatic false one.

CHAPTER 03 / QUESTIONS

# Practise eight common questions

Answer aloud. Keep notes about where you lose structure or become too vague.

- Why are you interested in this position?
- Tell me about your most relevant project.
- Describe a time you solved an unexpected problem.
- How do you prioritize competing deadlines?
- What is a skill you improved recently?
- Tell me about a time you received feedback.
- How would you handle an unfamiliar task?
- What would you like to ask us?

## AI mock-interview prompt

Act as a fair interviewer for [ROLE]. Ask one question at a time and wait for my response. Then provide concise feedback on relevance, evidence and clarity. Do not invent experience for me.

CHAPTER 04 / DELIVERY

# Sound prepared, not rehearsed

Good answers can be straightforward. Interviewers usually want to understand how you think and how you work.

## Before the interview

- Test audio and internet if the interview is remote.
- Have a copy of your resume and role description available.
- Plan your journey and arrive with time to spare.
- Prepare a calm opening and a thoughtful closing question.

## During the interview

- Listen fully before answering.
- Use one example rather than listing unsupported strengths.
- Ask for clarification when a question is ambiguous.
- Admit what you do not know and describe how you would learn.

Afterward, record which questions were challenging and improve your examples for future interviews.

CHAPTER 05 / PRACTICE SCHEDULE

# A five-day preparation routine

You can improve without expensive coaching. Make your practice short and deliberate.

| Day | Practice task |
|---|---|
| 1 | Read the role; identify three requirements and evidence for each. |
| 2 | Draft your introduction and two STAR stories. |
| 3 | Practise four questions aloud and record your answers. |
| 4 | Run a mock interview with a friend or AI, then review it. |
| 5 | Refine examples, research the company and prepare questions. |

## Measure what you can control

You can control preparation, truthful examples and professional communication. You cannot guarantee a hiring outcome or an interviewer’s preferences.

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